

XBCGD7312 (WIL) REPORT

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Table of Contents

1. List of Group Members and Their Responsibilities	4
2. Title of the Game	5
No Papers, No Peace.....	5
3. Links to the Game.....	5
GitHub Repository	5
itch.io Page	5
4. Explanation of the Serious Issue Addressed by the Game	5
5. Genre of the Game	6
6. Target Age Group	6
7. Pictures and Explanations of All Assets and Characters in the Game	6
7.1. Character Assets	6
7.2. Environment & Background Assets.....	7
7.3. Item & UI Assets	9
8. Game Rules, Game Specifications, and Player Instructions	11
8.1. Game Rules	11
8.2. Game Specifications	12
8.3. Player Instructions	13
9. Play Test Report.....	15
10. Minimum System Requirements.....	16
Minimum System Requirements (Windows PC)	16
11. Explanation and Description of the Game	16
11.1. Objective of the Game	16
11.2. Description of the Main Characters	17
11.3. Description of Game Assets	17
11.4. The Game World	18
11.5. Interface Design	18
11.6. Story and Narrative Progression.....	18
12. Screenshots Demonstrating the Game Journey	19
12.1. Campsite Introduction Scene.....	19
12.2. Home Affairs Queue Scene	20
12.3. Job Offer Notification.....	21

12.4.	Delivery Driving Game Scene	21
12.5.	Inventory or Document Tracking System	22
12.6.	End of Week or Time Progression Panel	23
12.7.	Successful Completion Scene	23
13.	Game Script (Mechanics Design Document)	24
13.1.	Overview	24
A.	CORE SYSTEMS	24
13.2.	Game State System	24
B.	EVENT SYSTEM	25
13.3.	Random Event Generation System	25
13.4.	Job Offer Event System.....	26
C.	MINI GAME SYSTEMS.....	26
13.8	Delivery Game Waypoint System	26
13.9.	3D Crafting Mini Game System (Food Preparation System)	27
14.	Text Script and Sound Design Document.....	28
14.1.	Text Script.....	28
A.	System Messages	29
B.	Home Affairs Queue Events.....	29
C.	Dialogue for NPCs	30
D.	Delivery Job Mini Game Text.....	30
E.	Crafting Mini Game	31
14.2.	Sound Design Document	31
15.	Core Mechanics of the Game	33
1.	Survival Management System	33
2.	Document Progression System	33
3.	Queue and Event System	34
4.	Inventory and Item System.....	34
5.	Crafting Mini Game (3D Food Preparation)	35
6.	Delivery Job Mini Game	35
7.	Money and Economy System	36
8.	Officer Interaction System	36
9.	Jail System	36

10.	Day and Week Cycle	37
11.	Win and Loss Conditions.....	37
16.	Tutorial Level	37
1.	Tutorial Purpose.....	38
2.	Narrative Backstory Introduction	38
3.	Tutorial Environment	38
4.	Helper Character: “Refugee Guide” Button	39
	Figure List:	40
	References	51

1. List of Group Members and Their Responsibilities

The development of *No Papers, No Peace* was collaboratively undertaken by a three-member team in which all members shared overall leadership of the programming and design processes. Responsibilities were distributed according to each member's strengths and technical focus:

Tapuwa Kabwato

- Development of core gameplay systems
- Event system architecture
- Delivery mini-game development
- Asset implementation and integration
- General programming contributions
- Report Documentation
- Pitch Presentation and PowerPoint
- Money System

Mark Perkins

- Player progression systems
- Home Affairs gameplay loop
- In-game documentation system (Section 22, renewals, bureaucratic mechanics)
- Narrative alignment for progression
- Balancing document timelines and difficulty
- Player Stats
- Map
- Some UI
- Sound Design
- Get Robed and Stealing events
- Project manger

Mpho Mugivhi

- Inventory system development
- Crafting mini-game development

- Asset creation and associated UI integration
- Supporting systems related to resource management

2. Title of the Game

No Papers, No Peace

A narrative-driven survival strategy game focused on the lived experiences of a refugee navigating the bureaucratic systems and social injustices in South Africa.

3. Links to the Game

GitHub Repository

<https://github.com/MegaSonicWarhead/WILPOE-Refugee-and-BureaucraticInjustice>

itch.io Page

<https://kinglilmeowing.itch.io/no-pa>

4. Explanation of the Serious Issue Addressed by the Game

No Papers, No Peace addresses the critical social issue of refugee marginalisation and bureaucratic injustice in disadvantaged communities within South Africa. Many refugees and asylum seekers endure long-term legal uncertainty due to systemic inefficiencies, corruption, and discriminatory practices within institutions such as the Department of Home Affairs. These issues directly affect their access to healthcare, education, employment, and safety (Khumalo, 2024; Scalabrini Institute, 2022).

Refugees often live in unstable environments, face xenophobic threats, and struggle to meet basic needs while navigating complicated documentation processes such as the issuance and renewal of Section 22 permits (UNHCR, [s.a.]). The game simulates this reality by placing the player in the role of a displaced individual who must manage survival resources, mental well-being, and bureaucratic challenges while confronting moral dilemmas shaped by poverty and desperation.

Through interactive storytelling, procedural events, and survival mechanics, the game raises awareness of the lived experiences of refugees and highlights the systemic issues that disadvantaged communities face daily. It encourages empathy and critical reflection on the societal structures that contribute to inequality and injustice.

5. Genre of the Game

No Papers, No Peace falls within the following genres:

- **Narrative-Driven Survival Strategy Game**
- **2D Top-Down Simulation / Resource Management**
- **Serious Game / Social Impact Game**

The game blends survival mechanics with narrative choices, creating an emotionally grounded experience that educates players about real-world humanitarian challenges. It contains elements similar to *Papers, Please* and *This War of Mine*, but uniquely focuses on the South African refugee experience.

6. Target Age Group

The game is designed for:

Primary Audience:

Ages 13+

Reason:

- The themes address mature social issues such as xenophobia, systemic corruption, psychological trauma, and moral dilemmas.
- Players aged 13+ are more likely to critically reflect on social injustices and engage with empathy-building narratives.
- The strategic and narrative depth is suited for young adults, university students, educators, and socially conscious gamers who can contextualise the humanitarian themes (Afrobarometer, 2021).

The game may be suitable for teenagers for educational contexts such as social studies or global studies classrooms.

7. Pictures and Explanations of All Assets and Characters in the Game

7.1. Character Assets

Asha Ahmed (Player Character)

- **Type:** 2D sprite (top-down / click-based representation)

- **Description:** Asha is a 28-year-old Somali refugee who serves as the main protagonist. Her sprite reflects her exhausted, displaced lifestyle—simple clothing, worn textures, and expressive facial features.
- **Purpose in Game:** Represents the emotional and physical struggle of navigating refugee life in South Africa.
- **Animations/States:** Idle, walking, interaction prompts.

Home Affairs Officers

- **Type:** 2D character sprites
- **Description:** Officers wear official-looking uniforms, with neutral or stern facial expressions to capture bureaucratic atmosphere.
- **Purpose in Game:** Appear in the Home Affairs scene during document processing, queues, and event interactions. Officers may refuse service, request bribes, or delay the player.

NPC Characters (Refugees & Community Members)

- **Type:** Multiple 2D sprites
- **Description:** Designed to represent different backgrounds, ages, and ethnicities within the refugee community. Includes parents, young adults, elderly figures, and children.
- **Purpose:** Used for side events, dialogue interactions, and environmental storytelling.

7.2. Environment & Background Assets

Refugee Campsite Scene

- **Description:**
A large outdoor environment representing the temporary living space outside Home Affairs. Includes:
 - Tents (single-sheet and multi-sheet paper textures reused stylistically)
 - Barrels, crates, discarded items
 - Ground textures showing dirt, a dirty river to wash yourself or drink water (if you cannot afford proper drinking water), and the harshness of living conditions with a dead rat even on the scene

- **Purpose:** Starting area where the player wakes up each day, reviews stats, and prepares actions.



Delivery Job Minigame Map

- **Description:**
A temporary job environment where players drive a delivery van. Includes:
 - Road tiles
 - Curbs and corners
 - Waypoint prefabs (green = current target, yellow = next waypoint)
- **Purpose:** Part of the job system that provides income opportunities to buy food and necessities.

Paid Assets:

https://syntystore.com/products/polygon-city-pack?_pos=1&_sid=1d22d3b79&_ss=r

Home Affairs Building Backgrounds

- **Description:**

Interior and exterior backgrounds with:

- Long queues
- Busy hallways
- Ticket machine areas
- Waiting chairs
- Flickering lights

- **Purpose:** Used for document processing sequences and random events.



Corner Shop / Street Areas

- **Description:**

Small informal stores where players can buy food, water, and other services. Includes shelving, counter textures, small signage, and ambient street props.

7.3. Item & UI Assets

Refugee Documentation Assets

Drawn in Krita in your previous work:

- **Single-Sheet Paper**
- **Multi-Sheet Bundle**

- **Paper Binder**
- **Blank Sheets**
- **Document Icons:** Section 22, Section 24, Biometrics, Interview papers
- **Purpose:** Represent the real-world paperwork refugees must obtain and maintain.

Inventory System Assets

- **Icons:** Food items, money, water, job tokens, crafting items
- **UI Panels:**
 - Simple bordered inventory boxes
 - Hover tooltips
 - Drag-and-drop item slots

Event System Icons

- **Load shedding symbol**
- **Weather event clouds (rain/cold)**
- **Health icons (heart, hunger, stress)**

Delivery Van

- **Type:** 2D sprite
- **Description:** Simple white/grey van with slight shading, used only in the delivery job minigame.
- **Animations:** Movement, rotation.

Job Offer Panel

- **Description:** There is a Job button that is a suitcase, click that button to open up the Job panel
- **Buttons:** “Delivery” button with a sprite of a guy on a bike, click that to open the Delivery Game

8. Game Rules, Game Specifications, and Player Instructions

This section outlines how the game functions, what rules guide gameplay, and how players interact with the systems inside *No Papers, No Peace*. It is written in a professional, academic style suitable for your WIL report.

8.1. Game Rules

Rule 1: One Primary Action per Day

Each in-game day, the player may choose a single major activity:

- Go to Home Affairs
- Look for work
- Accept a delivery job
- Rest at the campsite
- Search for food/water
- Visit a shop

This rule forces strategic planning and reflects real-world time limitations refugees face.

Rule 2: Documents Must Be Renewed Before Expiry

If the player fails to update or collect mandatory documents (e.g., Section 22 permit):

- Access to formal jobs becomes blocked
- Police encounters become more dangerous
- Risk of deportation increases

This mirrors the bureaucratic pressure present in real refugee systems.

Rule 3: Survival Stats Must Stay Above Zero

Three critical stats must be maintained:

- **Hunger**
- **Health**
- **Mental health/sanity**

If any stat reaches zero, the character may collapse, be hospitalized, or the game may end.

Rule 4: Money Is Required for Basic Needs

Players must work or take jobs to earn money. Without income, the player cannot:

- Buy food
- Pay for transport
- Pay bribes if choosing that path
- Repair or replace damaged documents

Rule 5: Actions Have Consequences

Decisions influence:

- Future events
- Refugee community opinions
- Access to help
- Officer attitudes at Home Affairs

The system ensures ethical decisions are meaningful.

8.2. Game Specifications

Technical Specifications

- **Engine:** Unity 6
- **Platform:** PC (Windows)
- **Gameplay Style:**
 - 2D top-down movement (limited)
 - Click-based actions
 - Narrative and event-driven
- **Scenes Used:**
 1. Campsite (main hub)
 2. Home Affairs
 3. Street / Shop
 4. Crafting & inventory scene
 5. Delivery Game (temporary job minigame)

System Specifications (Internal Game Systems)

- **Event System:** Controls random and scheduled daily events
- **Inventory System:** Designed by Mpho; handles items, tools, and crafting
- **Player Progression System:** Designed by Mark; controls documents & legal status
- **Job Delivery System:** Designed by Tapuwa; includes driving sequence and waypoint logic
- **GameState Manager:** Controls time, weeks, progression, and global flags

8.3. Player Instructions

Starting the Game

1. The player begins at the **Campsite** with limited resources.
2. A tutorial prompt explains hunger, money, mental health, and documentation requirements.
3. The player chooses a daily action.

Available Actions

1. Go to Home Affairs

- Stand in line
- Wait for officers
- Face possible delays
- Collect/renew documentation

Be prepared for long queues, corruption, or load shedding.

2. Find Work

Work opportunities include:

- Small temporary tasks
- Delivery van minigame
- Informal street jobs

Work increases money at the cost of time and hunger.

3. Delivery Job

How to start playing:

Click the suitcase with the name 'Job' that is placed on the Campsite scene to open on the Job Panel then select the delivery option to get into the delivery game.

In the Delivery Game:

- Follow a sequence of waypoints
- Earn payment on completion
- Return to campsite via "Return" button

4. Search for Food/Water

Visit the corner shop or interact with street vendors.
Food restores hunger but costs money.

5. Rest

Resting restores:

- Health
- Mental health

But consumes the entire day and does not progress documents.

6. Crafting / Inventory

Using Mpho's system, players may:

- Combine items
- Repair shelters
- Manage resources
- Read acquired documents

Inventory is accessed via UI panel.

Progressing Through the Game**Weekly Cycle**

- 4 days per week
- 12 weeks total

Each week becomes harder with more severe events.

Win Condition

Acquire:

- Asylum Application Form
- ID
- Biometrics
- Travel Document
- First Interview outcome

This leads to **Completed Application**.

Lose Conditions

- Hunger reaches zero
- Mental health collapses
- Player is deported
- Character dies (illness event)

9. Play Test Report

This section will document playtest changes

- Improved the UI in the Post Office, Bank, and Embassy scenes to look more professional, clean, and organized.
- Added sound effects to the Home Affairs scene to enhance player feedback and atmosphere.
- Crafting scene assets were implemented to match the overall scope and function of the scene. Added stylised UI unique to the game for consistency.
- Campsite scene had multiple UI changes to improve the overall look and vibe of the game. Such as icons, colour schemes buttons etc.
- Player stats UI sliders were also changed and improved. Before the changes the sliders looked out of place with the huge placeholder text that were bigger than the sliders themselves and the sliders in general were small. So, the sliders were made larger without any distracting text.
- The UI inventory was made to be dynamic, before the player could not click or interact with the inventory to ingest your inventory items. That was changed and now players can click and toggle items and ingest them or even use them if need be.
- The inventory was static before so players would acquire objects, and it would stay in the inventory and not refresh with each gameplay.
- Delivery way points improved to guide the player on the delivery route. Way points have responsive coloring showing a past and completed way point.

10. Minimum System Requirements

The following minimum system requirements were established to ensure that *No Papers, No Peace* runs smoothly across typical student and player devices. The game was developed in Unity, using 2D top-down environments, lightweight assets, and simple physics to ensure accessibility for a wide range of machines.

Minimum System Requirements (Windows PC)

Operating System:

Windows 10 (64-bit) or later

Processor:

Intel Core i3 (4th Generation) or AMD Ryzen 3 equivalent

Memory (RAM):

4 GB RAM

Graphics:

Integrated GPU (Intel HD Graphics 4000 or newer)

OR any dedicated GPU (NVIDIA/AMD, 1 GB VRAM)

Storage:

500 MB free space for game build and save data

Other Requirements:

Mouse or trackpad required

Keyboard required

11. Explanation and Description of the Game

11.1. Objective of the Game

No Papers, No Peace is a narrative focused serious game that aims to simulate the bureaucratic, social, and psychological challenges experienced by refugees and asylum seekers in South Africa. The primary objective is for the player to assist the main character, Asha Ahmed, in completing every step of the Home Affairs process before her legal protection period expires.

The player must make strategic decisions, gather the required documents, manage daily events, earn money through temporary jobs, and navigate unpredictable obstacles. The ultimate goal is to obtain the five required Home Affairs documents before the final week while maintaining Asha's wellbeing and survival.

11.2. Description of the Main Characters

Asha Ahmed

A Somali refugee who has recently arrived in South Africa. She must navigate unfamiliar systems, financial instability, and a demanding administrative environment. Asha is entirely dependent on the player's choices to progress, earn income, and avoid negative outcomes.

Home Affairs Officers

Non playable characters who represent the administrative system. They vary in attitude and reliability, reflecting the inconsistency found in real life bureaucratic settings.

Community Members

Supporting characters who appear in the settlement and city environments. They provide context, direction, and occasional narrative clues that help the player understand the broader challenges refugees face.

11.3. Description of Game Assets

The game includes the following major asset groups:

Refugee Assets

Models and sprites that represent Asha, camp shelters, objects found in informal settlements, and items related to refugee living conditions.

Campsite Scene

The main hub where the player begins the game. This area contains tents, shared living objects, and environmental props that reinforce the theme of survival.

Delivery Van

A functional vehicle used during the delivery job mini game. It is used as part of Asha's income generating activities.

Home Affairs Officers and Backgrounds

Props and background assets based on the layout of South African Home Affairs offices. These include waiting area furniture, posters, signage, and queue barriers.

11.4. The Game World

The game world is divided into several scenes that mirror the different parts of a refugee's daily experience in South Africa. These include the campsite where Asha lives, the Home Affairs office where she must follow a long administrative process, city areas where encounters and events occur, and the delivery job scene that functions as a temporary income source.

Each location uses purposeful design choices to emphasize the emotional and economic constraints faced by displaced individuals in the country.

11.5. Interface Design

The user interface is developed with Unity's Canvas system and TextMeshProUGUI to ensure readability and accessibility. It includes:

- A day and week tracker that reflects the urgency of the process
- A money display that persists across all scenes
- Event panels that appear during the daily cycle
- An inventory and document tracking system
- Job offer notifications that allow players to accept or decline work
- A clear Home Affairs progression bar that displays the current step

The interface is designed to communicate important information without overwhelming the player, while reinforcing the narrative tone of the game.

11.6. Story and Narrative Progression

The narrative begins with Asha waking up in a refugee campsite with limited resources. She is required to begin the Home Affairs application process and must do so under pressure from social, financial, and administrative barriers. The story progresses through several interconnected systems.

Home Affairs Progression System

The game follows five mandatory steps that Asha must complete in order. These include the Asylum Application Form, her ID, Biometrics, Travel Document, and finally the

Interview Confirmation. The GameState system ensures that these steps follow their required sequence.

Daily Events

Random events appear throughout each week. These events may benefit Asha or create new challenges. They often require the player to make difficult choices that can affect money, progress, or time.

Income Generation

The player occasionally receives job offers. If accepted, the player enters the delivery job mini game where they must complete driving tasks to earn money that will help Asha with food, transport, and application expenses.

Consequences

Poor choices, financial mismanagement, or delays in document acquisition can impact the outcome of the game. If Asha fails to complete the application within the twelve week period, the player receives an ending that reflects the consequences of not securing legal protection.

12. Screenshots Demonstrating the Game Journey

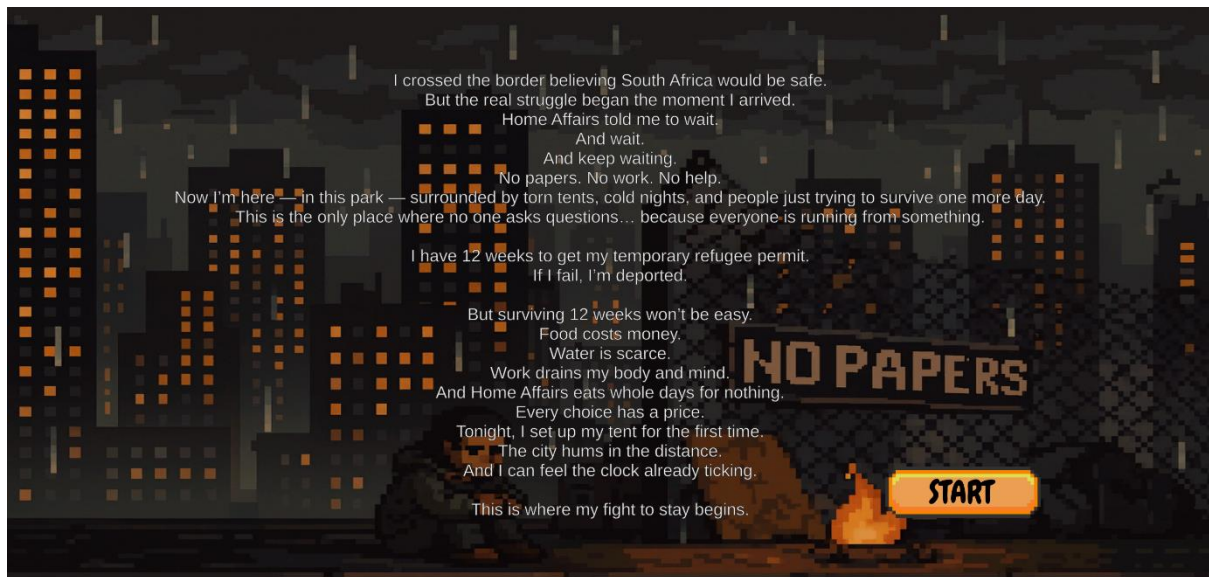
This section outlines the required screenshots and descriptions that must be inserted into the final report document. The purpose of these screenshots is to visually illustrate the narrative experience, core mechanics, and moment to moment gameplay of *No Papers, No Peace*. Each screenshot should be placed in the report at the indicated locations along with the corresponding caption.

12.1. Campsite Introduction Scene

Description for the Report:

This screenshot should depict Asha's initial living environment in the refugee campsite. It must show the tents, shared living facilities, and introductory UI elements such as the day counter and money display. This environment sets the emotional tone of the game while contextualising the challenges Asha faces from the beginning.

Screenshot:



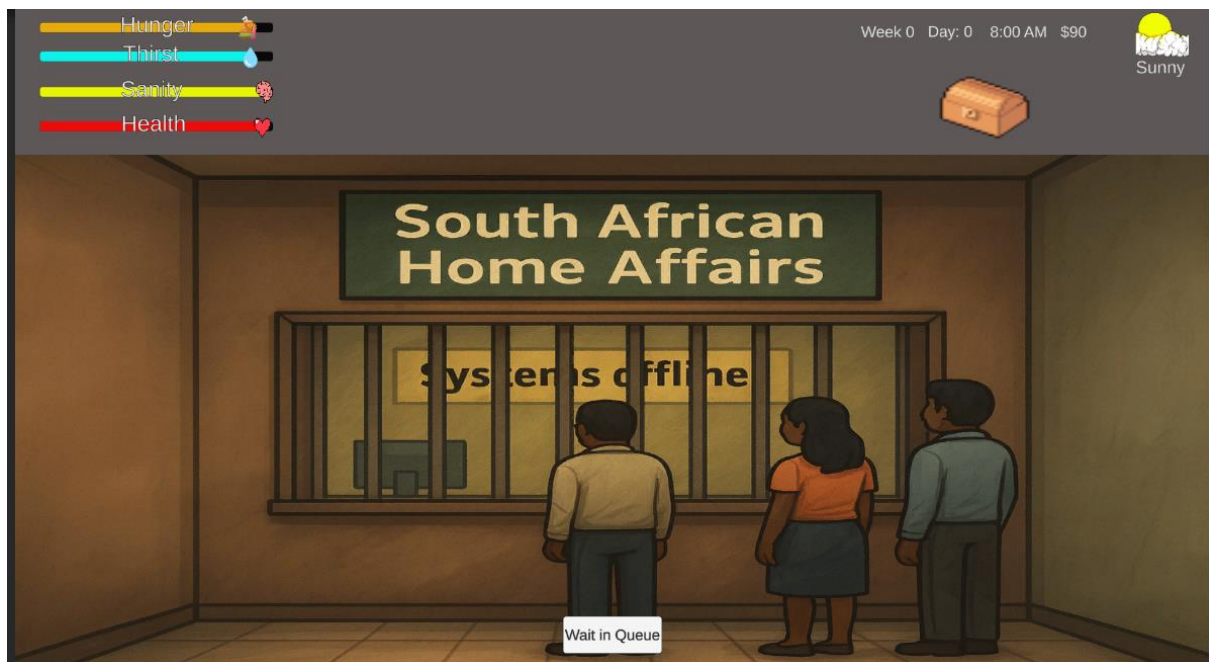
Caption: The player begins the game in the refugee campsite where Asha lives.

12.2. Home Affairs Queue Scene

Description for the Report:

This screenshot should show the Home Affairs waiting area including the line management ropes, the seating, and the officer desks. The screenshot must also display the document progression UI on screen. This image represents the bureaucratic focus of the game and the main progression system.

Screenshot:



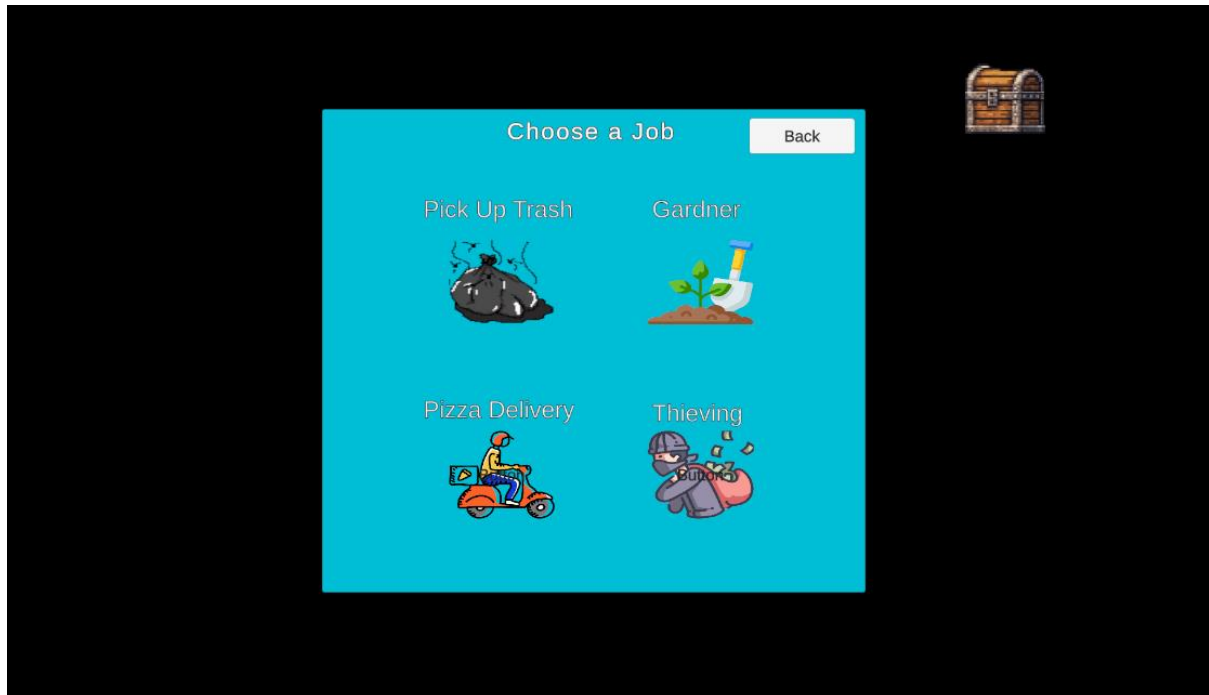
Caption: Asha attempts to progress through the Home Affairs application system.

12.3. Job Offer Notification

Description for the Report:

This screenshot must show the job offer panel that appears during the daily cycle. The screenshot should include the job buttons. This demonstrates the employment system that allows Asha to earn money.

Screenshot:



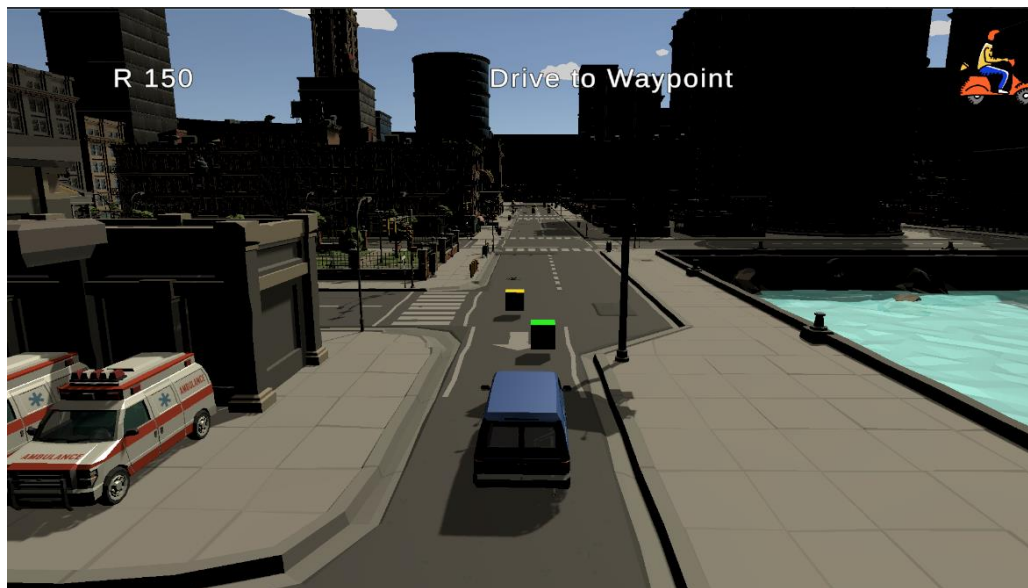
Caption: A job offer appears allowing the player to earn money through temporary work.

12.4. Delivery Driving Game Scene

Description for the Report:

This screenshot should show the player inside the delivery mini game. The scene must display the delivery van, waypoint indicators, the active task UI, and the road layout. This demonstrates the functional gameplay aspect where the player earns income.

Screenshot:



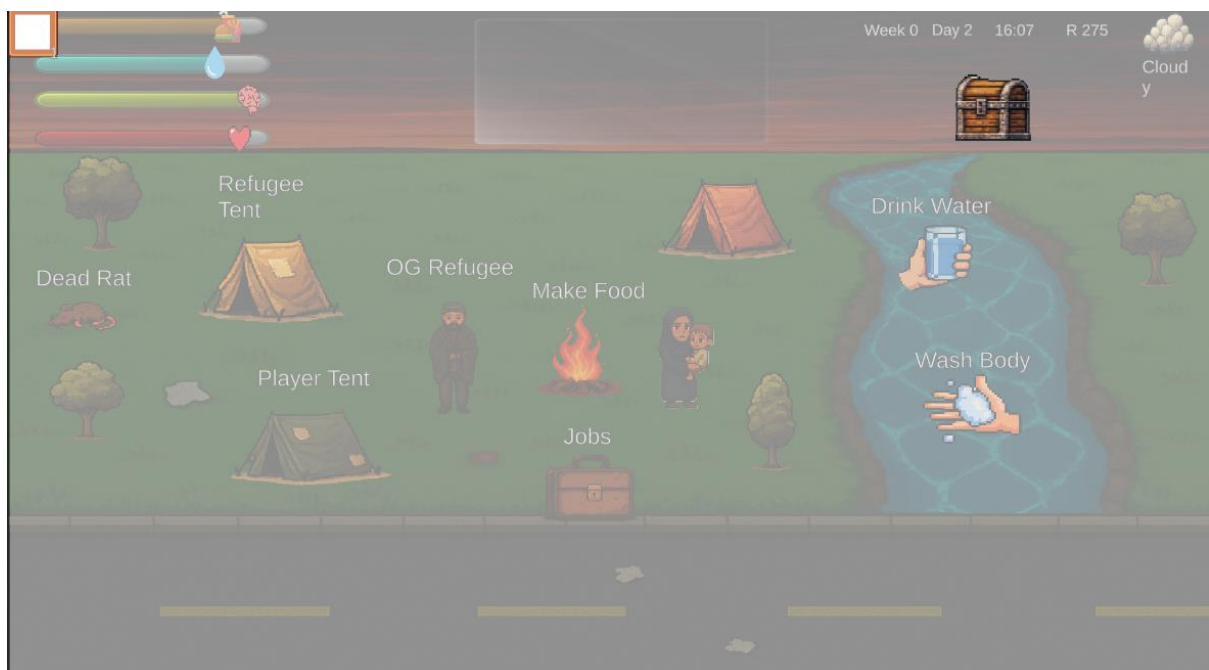
Caption: The delivery job mini game where players navigate waypoints to complete deliveries.

12.5. Inventory or Document Tracking System

Description for the Report:

This screenshot should show the UI element that tracks which Home Affairs documents Asha has obtained. It may be an inventory panel or a checklist UI. The screenshot highlights the structured progression system.

Screenshot:



Caption: The document tracking system displays Asha's progress in acquiring required paperwork.

12.6. End of Week or Time Progression Panel

Description for the Report:

This screenshot should show the UI state at the end of a week. It demonstrates the time pressure mechanic and how players must plan strategically.



Screenshot:

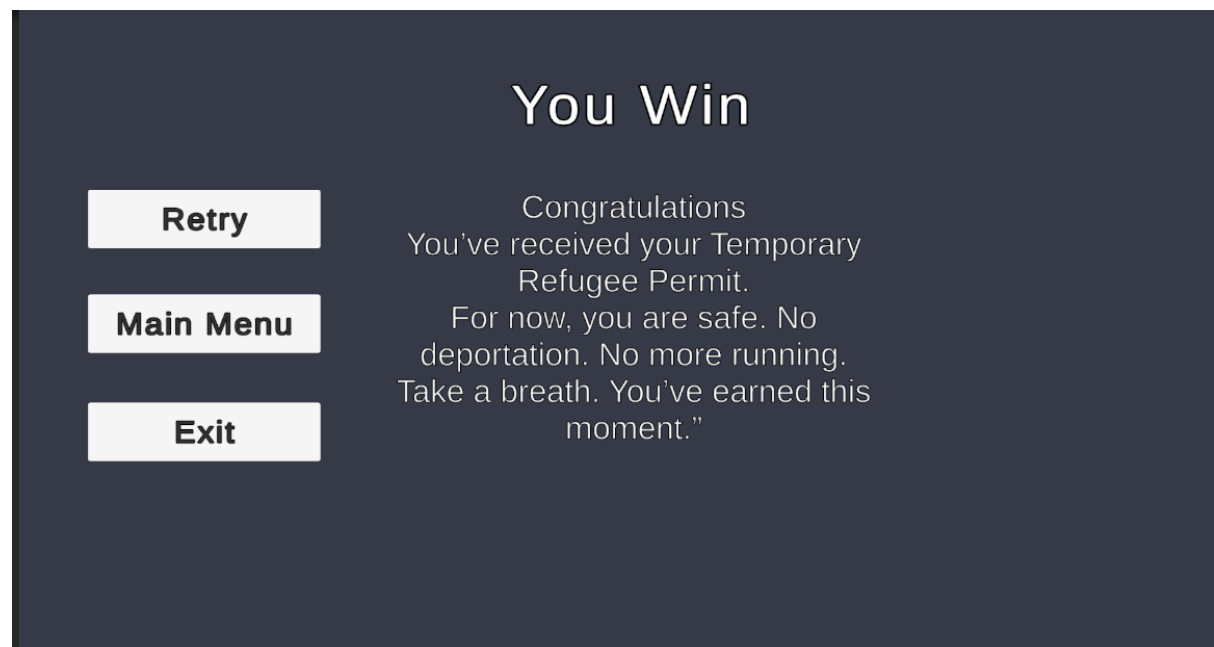
Caption: The game tracks weeks and days, placing pressure on the player to progress.

12.7. Successful Completion Scene

Description for the Report:

This screenshot should show the final completion message or scene once all documents are obtained. This should capture the emotional payoff and narrative resolution.

Screenshot:



Caption: Completion of all required documents leads to Asha's successful interview and final outcome.

13. Game Script (Mechanics Design Document)

A detailed breakdown of all gameplay systems, rules, logic flows and interactions implemented in the game.

13.1. Overview

This Mechanics Design Document explains the core systems, rules and behaviours that define the interactive structure of *No Papers, No Peace*. The game combines narrative choice, resource management, survival systems, randomised events and mini game mechanics to simulate the experience of a refugee navigating the South African asylum process. All mechanics reinforce themes such as administrative delay, precarity and moral tension.

A. CORE SYSTEMS

13.2. Game State System

Purpose

The GameState script controls all persistent data that spans across scenes and prevents reset between transitions. It ensures a consistent world state as the player progresses across days, weeks and application stages.

Tracked Variables

- Player progression stage
- Current day and week
- Whether a clue was given today
- Which documents have been acquired
- A record of all clues given
- Game completion state

Functional Logic

1. The GameState object is created once and persists across scenes.
2. Each day increments when the player completes a cycle.
3. Every fourth day increments the week counter.

4. If the player reaches week twelve without completion, the game reaches a fail state.
5. Document acquisition automatically checks if the player satisfies the requirements for the next stage of the asylum process.
6. Once all documents are collected, progression is marked as complete.

B. EVENT SYSTEM

13.3. Random Event Generation System

Purpose

Randomised hardship events recreate the unpredictability of refugee life. Events occur during the daily cycle and affect resources, health, progress or employment opportunities.

Trigger Conditions

- Events may trigger when a new day begins.
- Probability weighting determines whether a hardship event appears.
- The system uses a random selector but does not reveal odds to the player.

Event Examples

- Lost documents
- Street robbery
- Load shedding
- Corrupt official requesting a bribe
- Community assistance from another refugee

Event Outcome Workflow

1. The event triggers.
2. The Event Panel opens with an outcome title and description.
3. Player presses the continue button.
4. The system applies consequences such as losing money, gaining stress, or missing a day.
5. The panel closes.

13.4. Job Offer Event System

Purpose

Provides optional income through a delivery mini game. Works independently of the hardship events.

Trigger Conditions

- Random chance during the morning or afternoon cycle.
- Panel appears offering a job.
- The player may accept or decline.

Accept Flow

- Scene loads into the DeliveryGame scene.
- The player performs the delivery mission.
- Completion triggers the reward panel.
- Upon pressing return, the player is sent back to the Campsite scene.

Decline Flow

- Panel closes.
- Day resumes normally.

C. MINI GAME SYSTEMS

13.8 Delivery Game Waypoint System

Purpose

Provides a skill based mini game that rewards the player with income.

Mechanics

- Player controls a van in a 3D driving scene.
- Two waypoint prefabs exist at all times.
- One is green and indicates the next active target.
- One is yellow and shows the upcoming target.

Flow Logic

1. Player enters the green waypoint trigger.
2. That waypoint is destroyed.
3. The yellow waypoint turns green.
4. A new yellow waypoint spawns at the next location.
5. When all waypoints are completed, the “Job Done” panel appears.
6. Player clicks the button to return to the campsite.

13.9. 3D Crafting Mini Game System (Food Preparation System)

Purpose

The 3D Crafting Mini Game system provides a secondary method for players to obtain food without relying exclusively on shops or events. This system strengthens survival mechanics by giving the player an active role in food production. The crafting mini game also serves as a complementary system to the Hunger mechanic and supports long term sustainability for the player inside the refugee campsite.

Environment and Scene Structure

The food crafting system takes place in a standalone 3D scene designed as a small makeshift kitchen or cooking area found within the campsite. The environment includes:

- A 3D worktable where ingredients are placed
- Interactive ingredient objects
- A cooking pot or pan object
- Crafting UI overlays
- A result panel that shows the cooked food item

This creates a grounded, realistic context that reflects the improvisational cooking setups seen in displacement communities.

Core Mechanics

Ingredient Collection

The crafting game begins by presenting the player with available ingredients. These ingredients may represent:

- Raw maize
- Vegetables
- Canned beans
- Water
- Basic spices

The player selects ingredients that appear as 3D interactable objects on the worktable.

Interaction and Combination

The crafting mechanic uses a simple combination system:

1. The player clicks on ingredients.
2. Selected ingredients move into the cooking pot.
3. A crafting meter or progress animation begins.
4. After completion, the system evaluates the recipe.

Outcome and Rewards

The crafting mini game produces a food item that is added to the player's inventory system. These items restore hunger and support survival progression.

Reward Flow

1. The crafting animation finishes.
2. A result UI panel opens.
3. The player sees a food icon, name and description.
4. The player clicks continue.
5. The food is added to inventory.
6. The player is returned to the campsite scene.

14. Text Script and Sound Design Document

14.1. Text Script

The text script contains all written interactions that occur in *No Papers, No Peace*. The script includes dialogue, event text, narrative exposition, system notifications and UI instructions. The writing aims to support emotional depth, narrative coherence and

clarity for player decision making. The tone remains grounded and realistic in order to reflect the lived experiences of refugees navigating bureaucratic and social hardship.

A. System Messages

These messages appear during general gameplay activities and inform the player about changes in status, progression or resource management.

Day and Time Notifications

- A new day has begun.
- You are feeling hungry.
- You have advanced to Week [X].
- Your sanity has decreased due to stress.

Document Progression Messages

- You have acquired the Asylum Application Form.
- You have successfully completed your biometrics.
- You have received an interview date.
- Your application has progressed to the next stage.

Random Event Notifications

- You were pushed back in the queue.
- Load shedding has disrupted processing for the day.
- A security officer dismissed you without explanation.
- Your documents were misplaced, and you must return tomorrow.
- Someone ahead of you offered to sell you a faster place in the line.

B. Home Affairs Queue Events

These texts support the events generated by the queue system.

Queue Delay Example

- You waited for several hours, but the line barely moved.
- A staff member told everyone to return tomorrow.
- You overheard rumours of corruption inside the office.

Positive Outcome Example

- The official accepted your papers without issue.
- You successfully completed this step of the process.
- Today's session progressed smoothly.

C. Dialogue for NPCs

Campsite NPC Dialogue

Fellow Refugee

- I have been here for months. They keep telling me to come back tomorrow.
- If you have extra food, please help me. I have not eaten today.
- The officials only listen to people who have money. The rest of us wait outside like animals.

Elderly Woman

- I had a home once. Now I wait here every day hoping they call my name.
- We survive by helping each other. Do not lose your humanity.

Home Affairs Officer Dialogue

Officer 1

- Your documents are incomplete. Return next week.
- Stand back. The line is full for today.
- If you cannot provide proof, I cannot help you.

Officer 2 (Corruption Event)

- I may be able to help you, but these things require persuasion.
- If you are willing to make it worth my time, we can move you forward.

D. Delivery Job Mini Game Text

Job Offer Panel

- A local shopkeeper is offering you a temporary delivery job.
- Payment will be provided upon successful delivery.

- Would you like to accept the job?

Pickup and Delivery Messages

- Package collected. Proceed to the next waypoint.
- Delivery successful.
- You earned R[amount] for your work today.

Completion Panel

- Job complete. Return to the campsite.

E. Crafting Mini Game

Ingredient Selection

- Select ingredients to begin cooking.
- You do not have enough ingredients to prepare this meal.

Cooking Process

- Preparing your meal. Please wait.
- The mixture is starting to boil.
- Cooking complete.

Crafting Outcome

- You cooked a meal: [Food Item Name].
- The meal has been added to your inventory.
- The ingredients did not combine correctly. Meal failed.

14.2. Sound Design Document

Pleas not all the sounds was free.

stamp post office mail.wav BY frank_the_noise was used in the Post Offices room as ambient sound. https://freesound.org/people/frank_the_noise/sounds/160879/

Office and UPS sounds 3.wav BY Zabuhailo was used in Post Offices,Bank,Home Affairs and Embassy as ambient sound.

<https://freesound.org/people/Zabuhailo/sounds/166019/>

village park 12.03 PM 220503_0341 BY klankbeeld was used in Campsite as ambient sound. <https://freesound.org/people/klankbeeld/sounds/699433/>

A Song About Acheiving Greatness BY Seth_Makes_S... was use in Main Menu, Background scene and Death scene and Win scene as ambient sound.

https://freesound.org/people/Seth_Makes_Sounds/sounds/674940/

traffic light from 3rd floor window or balcony NYC, USA.flac BY kyles was used in 3d pizza delivery min game as ambient sound.

<https://freesound.org/people/kyles/sounds/452991/>

Shopping mall sounds By SpinOpel was used in Shop scene as ambient sound.

<https://freesound.org/people/SpinOpel/sounds/835092/>

Open Map By freesound_CrunchpixSt was used in Map scene as map open sound effect. <https://pixabay.com/sound-effects/open-map-384948/>

Sizzling/Cooking food By OxidVideos was used in 3D Food crafting station as making food effect. <https://pixabay.com/sound-effects/sizzlingcooking-food-414300/>

15. Core Mechanics of the Game

The core mechanics of *No Papers, No Peace* were designed to simulate the bureaucratic, psychological and material struggles experienced by asylum seekers navigating the South African refugee system. These mechanics intentionally combine survival systems, document progression, chance-based events and socially grounded mini games to deliver a serious and impactful learning experience.

1. Survival Management System

The player must manage four key survival indicators that reflect the physical and emotional strain of displacement.

Stats

- Health
- Hunger
- Thirst
- Sanity

Mechanics

- Each new in-game day reduces hunger and thirst automatically.
- Failing to eat or drink decreases health and sanity.
- Lack of sleep increases mental strain.
- Polluted water restores thirst while risking health.
- Food crafted in the campsite restores hunger and health.

These mechanics ensure that the player cannot ignore basic needs while navigating the bureaucracy, emphasising how survival and documentation pressure coexist in real life.

2. Document Progression System

The game uses a structured five-step progression system aligned with official DHA refugee processes.

Document Stages

1. Asylum Application Form (DHA-1590)
2. ID Document

3. Biometrics
4. Travel Document
5. First Interview Confirmation

Mechanics

- Each document is obtained from a specific location such as Home Affairs, Post Office, Embassy or Bank.
- The player must speak to officers, navigate clues and avoid misinformation.
- Submitting the correct document moves the player to the next progression stage.
- Wrong documents may be sold to the player, causing delays and financial setbacks.
- Corrupt officers may demand bribes.
- Systems may be offline, forcing the player to return the next day.

This mechanic highlights the real-world bureaucratic barriers refugees experience.

3. Queue and Event System

The Home Affairs interaction is driven by a randomised event system inspired by real patterns of instability.

Possible Events

- Systems outage
- Queue reset
- Sudden closure
- Successful processing
- Officer corruption
- Wrong document misdirection

These events force the player to adapt and reflect uncertainty that refugees face in daily administrative processes.

4. Inventory and Item System

The game uses a persistent inventory that stores:

- Documents
- Food items
- Crafted meals
- Raw ingredients
- Special event items

Mechanics

- Items can be added, removed and consumed.
- Documents must be stored safely until submission.
- Ingredients collected from the campsite can be used in crafting.

This system supports both the survival and bureaucratic gameplay loops.

5. Crafting Mini Game (3D Food Preparation)

The crafting system allows players to combine ingredients inside a physical 3D bowl.

Mechanics

- Players drag 3D ingredients into a bowl using a physics-based drag system.
- Recipes consist of two specific ingredients that produce a meal.
- Meals restore hunger and sometimes sanity.
- Invalid ingredient combinations produce nothing.

This reinforces day-to-day refugee survival where food scarcity is common and resourcefulness matters.

6. Delivery Job Mini Game

To simulate unstable informal employment, the player can accept a temporary delivery job.

Mechanics

- Player enters a timed delivery scene.
- They must drive a van through checkpoints and deliver packages.
- Completion rewards money used for documents or bribes.

- Failure results in no payment.

This mechanic demonstrates how many asylum seekers rely on unpredictable, low-paying informal jobs.

7. Money and Economy System

Money is essential for progression.

Mechanics

- The player earns money through the delivery mini game.
- Money is used to purchase documents.
- Corrupt officers may require bribes.
- Running out of money slows progression and increases survival risk.

This adds economic pressure reflective of migrant realities.

8. Officer Interaction System

Officer encounters use a choice-based dialogue system.

Mechanics

- Dialogues change based on the current progression stage.
- Nice, neutral and corrupt officers offer different guidance.
- Corrupt officers activate bribe options.
- Officers can give clues, misinformation or direct instructions.

This mechanic mirrors real interpersonal barriers refugees face in administrative centres.

9. Jail System

Failure to comply or certain events may lead to detention.

Mechanics

- Player is jailed for a set number of days.
- Survival stats reset except sanity, which drops.

- Player cannot perform tasks while jailed.
- After release, normal gameplay resumes.

This mechanic reflects the vulnerability of people without valid papers.

10. Day and Week Cycle

Progression operates on a structured time cycle.

Mechanics

- Every four days equals one week.
- Documents can only be obtained or submitted on certain days.
- Events reset daily.

Going through the system takes several in-game weeks, emphasizing long-term struggle.

11. Win and Loss Conditions

Win Condition

- Player collects all documents and completes the refugee application process.

Loss Conditions

- Critical survival failure such as zero health.
- Running out of time after 12 weeks.

These conditions reinforce urgency and vulnerability.

16. Tutorial Level

The tutorial level in *No Papers, No Peace* introduces players to the core themes, controls, and survival pressures without overwhelming them. It focuses on narrative orientation, basic UI guidance, and gentle onboarding to the game's mechanics.

The tutorial uses a combination of story exposition, environmental visuals, and an interactive helper character to teach players how to navigate life as a refugee living outside Home Affairs.

1. Tutorial Purpose

The tutorial aims to:

- Introduce the player to the backstory of Asha Ahmed, the main character.
- Establish the tone and serious issue addressed by the game.
- Explain the basic UI, movement, inventory, and document progression system.
- Provide the player with first steps toward survival and bureaucratic navigation.
- Prepare players for the resource pressure and emotional journey of the full game.

2. Narrative Backstory Introduction

When the game starts, the tutorial begins with a short narrative sequence explaining:

- Asha's arrival in South Africa.
- Her displacement from Somalia due to conflict, instability, and loss.
- The harsh reality of living outside Home Affairs in Johannesburg.
- The conditions of overcrowded camps, corruption, and survival uncertainty.

This backstory is delivered through:

- On-screen text panels
- Static backgrounds of the campsite
- Slow ambient sound and music
- A final transition into the playable scene

The tutorial ensures players understand the emotional weight and purpose of the game before engaging with system mechanics.

3. Tutorial Environment

The player is placed in the campsite scene, which functions as the tutorial zone.

This area includes:

- A tent representing the player's shelter

- A cooking space used later for crafting
- Other refugee NPCs standing in the background
- Low-detail props demonstrating poverty and overcrowding

Only limited interactions are available to avoid overwhelming new players.

4. Helper Character: “Refugee Guide” Button

The tutorial includes a special UI element:

A clickable sprite of a refugee helper, positioned in the bottom-right corner of the screen.

Role of the Helper Character

When clicked:

- It displays tips, hints, and instructions.
- It explains important elements such as hunger, money, Home Affairs visits, and crafting.
- It guides players through each step of the tutorial, one message at a time.
- It reappears throughout the game for additional support.

This helper acts as a friendly, non-intrusive way to onboard the player without large text block

Figure List:



Figure 1: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D Pixel Shop*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 2: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D Pixel Outside Public Bathroom*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 3: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D Pixel Embassy*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 4: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D pixel South African Post Office*. (ChatGPT, 2025)

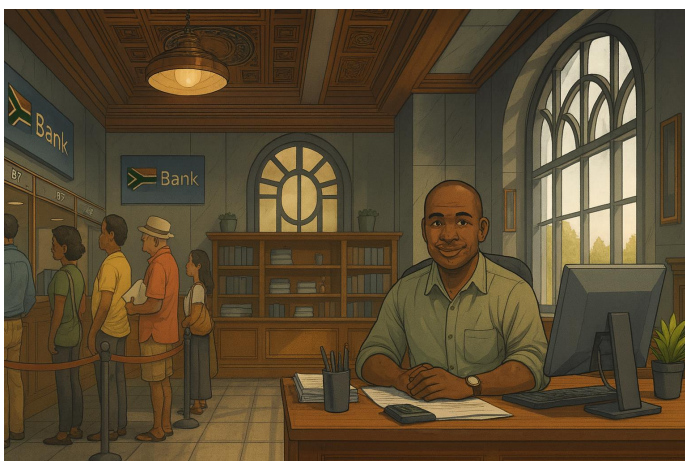


Figure 5: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D pixel South African Bank*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 6: ChatGPT. [SA]. 2D pixel South African Home Affairs. (ChatGPT, 2025)

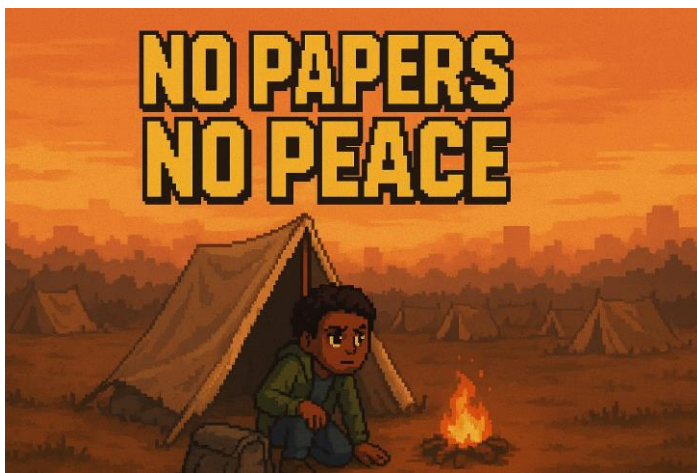


Figure 7: ChatGPT. [SA]. No Papers No Peace Poster. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 8: ChatGPT. [SA]. grass landscape with city roads pixel. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 9: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Thieve stealing pixel icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 10: ChatGPT. [SA]. *gadering pixel icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 11: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Officer pixel icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 12: ChatGPT. [SA]. *brain pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 13: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Food pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)

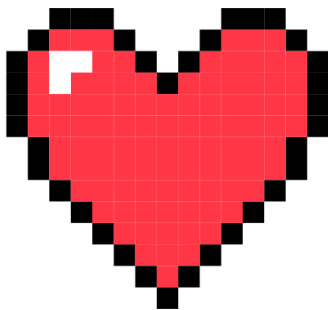


Figure 14: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Game hart pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 15: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Water droplet pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 16: ChatGPT. [SA]. *bank pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 17: ChatGPT. [SA]. *campsite pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)

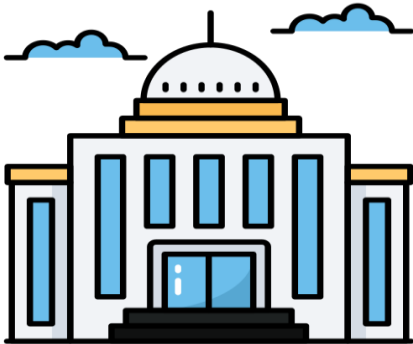


Figure 18: ChatGPT. [SA]. *embassy pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 19: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Post office pixel icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)

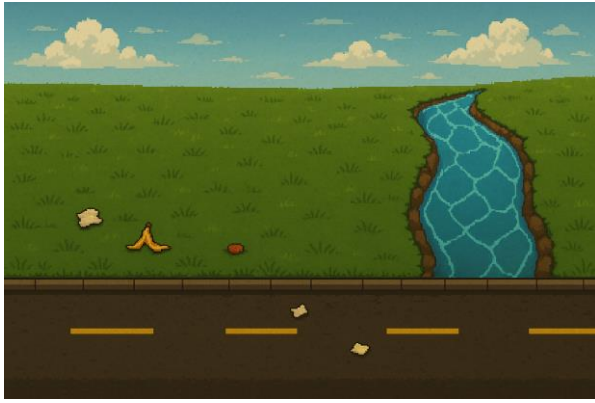


Figure 20: ChatGPT. [SA]. *grass landscape with city roads and river and trash with horizan pixel.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 21: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2d refugee full body pixel character.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 22: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Background for Bank Scene.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 23: ChatGPT. [SA]. *South African Home Affairs Background.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 24: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Delivery panel pop up after delivery is done.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 25: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Deportation Screen after player is deported.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 26: ChatGPT. [SA]. *UI panel overlay.* (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 27: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Player Death Cover*. (ChatGPT, 2025)

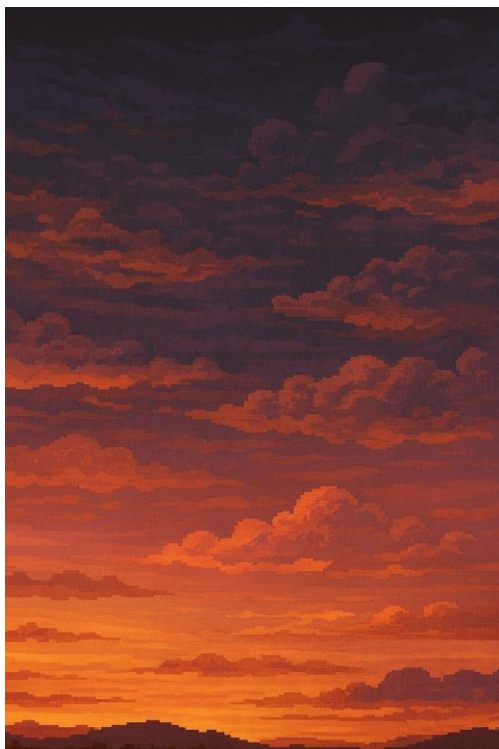


Figure 28: ChatGPT. [SA]. *UI panel sunset overlay*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 29: ChatGPT. [SA]. *OG refugee game icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 30: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Inventory chest*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 31: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Dead rat*. (ChatGPT, 2025)

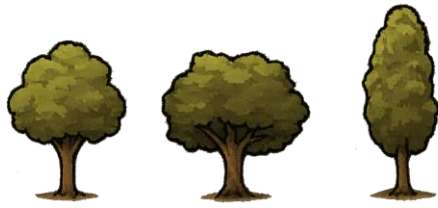


Figure 32: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Campsite trees*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 33: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Drink water icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 34: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Wash hand icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 35: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Job bag icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 36: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Camp fire icon*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 37: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Camp tents icons*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 38: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Back story cover*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 39: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Shop items*. (ChatGPT, 2025)



Figure 40: ChatGPT. [SA]. Win screen. (ChatGPT, 2025)

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List of Figures:

Figure 1: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D Pixel Shop*.

Figure 2: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D Pixel Outside Public Bathroom*.

Figure 3: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D Pixel Embassy*.

Figure 4: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D pixel South African Post Office*.

Figure 5: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D pixel South African Bank.*

Figure 6: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2D pixel South African Home Affairs.*

Figure 7: ChatGPT. [SA]. *No Papers No Peace Poster.*

Figure 8: ChatGPT. [SA]. *grass landscape with city roads pixel.*

Figure 9: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Thieve stealing pixel icon.*

Figure 10: ChatGPT. [SA]. *gathering pixel icon.*

Figure 11: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Officer pixel icon.*

Figure 12: ChatGPT. [SA]. *brain pixel icon.*

Figure 13: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Food pixel icon.*

Figure 14: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Game hart pixel icon.*

Figure 15: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Water droplet pixel icon.*

Figure 16: ChatGPT. [SA]. *bank pixel icon.*

Figure 17: ChatGPT. [SA]. *campsite pixel icon.*

Figure 18: ChatGPT. [SA]. *embassy pixel icon.*

Figure 19: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Post office pixel icon.*

Figure 20: ChatGPT. [SA]. *grass landscape with city roads and river and trash with horizon pixel.*

Figure 21: ChatGPT. [SA]. *2d refugee full body pixel character.*

Figure 22: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Background for Bank Scene.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 23: ChatGPT. [SA]. *South African Home Affairs Background.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 24: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Delivery panel pop up after delivery is done.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 25: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Deportation Screen after player is deported.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 26: ChatGPT. [SA]. *UI panel overlay.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 27: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Player Death Cover.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 28: ChatGPT. [SA]. *UI panel sunset overlay.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 29: ChatGPT. [SA]. *OG refugee game icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 30: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Inventory chest.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 31: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Dead rat.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 32: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Campsite trees.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 33: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Drink water icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 34: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Wash hand icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 35: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Job bag icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 36: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Camp fire icon.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 37: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Camp tents icons.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 38: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Back story cover.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 39: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Shop items.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

Figure 40: ChatGPT. [SA]. *Win screen.* (ChatGPT, 2025)

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